Raid Farms: A symbol of resistance

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Background

Raid Farms was a server experiment started by YouTuber PineconeLP that described itself as a "semi-anarchyish[sic] Minecraft server with a unique blend of features," intending to "…make Minecraft servers fun again". The server's establishment followed a video made by PineconeLP titled "Why Most Minecraft Servers Are Boring," which described the need for anarchy and pvp in order to achieve fun in a server.

However, since its launch on the 16th of November 2025, players have gradually lost interest and became bored of the server. On the 1st of March 2026, Raid Farms officially shut down. [3][5][6]

Despite its downfall, Raid Farms was a unique and interesting experiment. Through its ups and downs, its playerbase largely stayed put and anticipated for the next big change.

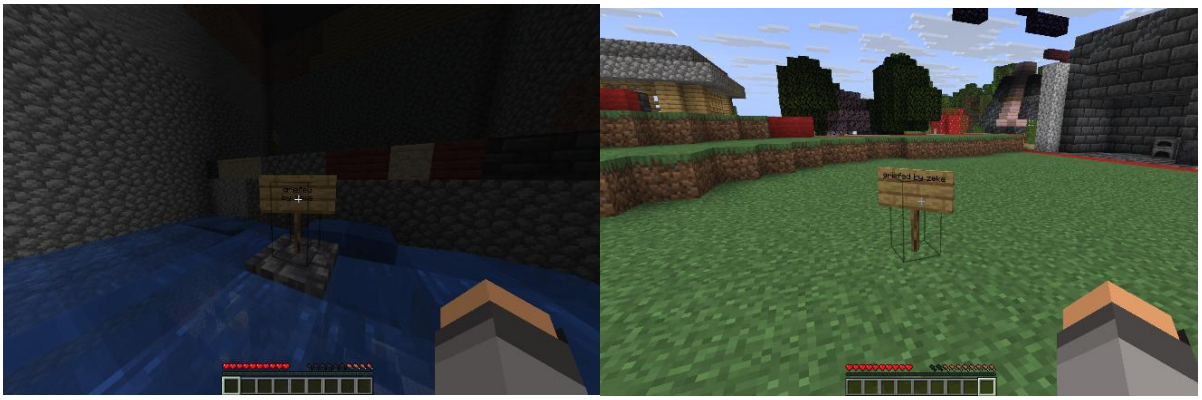
This article will focus on how these players bonded, established communities, and seemingly played against the server's established intentions.

I. The spawn square

Most new players' experience of Raid Farms would be its spawn area – the 100 by 100 metre square that serves as the centre of the server, houses shop and studio apartment plots, and has a quaint lake where players can fish. The square also has PvP protection and is the only area in the entire world where griefing is banned, which explains why immediately outside the square massive, towering cobblestone structures loom over you.



Although, despite the initial unsettling feeling that the griefing brings, these structures actually provide valuable nostalgia and realism to the server, reinforcing the sense of community early on in a new player's experience. Each skyscraper tells a story of history, previous player interactions, and a once lively community that made a boring wilderness have a sense of character, even if it is unsightly.



An infamous griefer was Zeke, who has a celebrity-like status within the server. He has a presence in the form of signs around the whole world, signed with “griefed by zeke”. Zekethegameboy. [8]

II. The tunnel



Notice the cobblestone, dirt, and other planks dotted around on the seafloor. Players try to adapt to traverse the tricky terrain, but the many breaks in between show they usually resort to other ways of travel (e.g. on top of the mangrove trees).

I came across a tunnel running outside the Raid Farm’s spawn square that ran under a waterlogged swamp, eventually emerging into the outskirts of a savannah.

The diagonal passageway reminded me of foot tunnels under rumbly tube tracks in London, loosely put together, filthy everywhere, and littered with masses of cigarette butts and random splashes of paint. The imperfectness of this tunnel describes Raid Farms as a server very well. It embodies the spirit of anarchy in all its forms – carelessness, disorder, and chaos.

In servers where griefing is permitted and has no restrictions, the time and effort required to build a building will always be greater than the effort required to destroy it with TNT. The ragtag-like presentation and composition of the tunnel is a result of players understanding this fact. The result is a randomly, carelessly repaired, unmanaged tunnel. I will refer to this phenomenon as the *Griefing Imbalance*.

In a server where griefing is banned, plots are enabled, and almost all players do not *want* to grief, a nicer looking tunnel made of planks, logs, and lit with lanterns may have been built. Helpful signs along the way would guide players to their destinations.

However, in Raid Farms, such a construction would be an extremely large risk. A griefer could easily destroy the tunnel that took hours, even days to build, in seconds. The large structures

around spawn also amplify to naive new players that such efforts are welcomed, but also warns that it is likely to be short-lived.

You may conclude because of this that Raid Farms is a disconnected, unfriendly community due to its hostile architecture. Nevertheless, like *Cialazar*, a town I will talk about in the next section, the message that is associated with the unpolished tunnel is what makes the server have an unseen community. It communicates the resistance and resilience of players in the server despite its circumstances. So, in fact, the Raid Farms community is stronger than any other.

III. Cialazar



To the four cardinal directions around the square, there are many bridges made from cheap, easy-to-find materials running in parallel with each other, seemingly leading nowhere. This is the first of many examples in Raid Farms where the consequences of its anarchic nature are displayed through the structure's composition.



At the end of one of these bridges, you are greeted with a sign showing the city's name – *Cialazar* – apparently named after its founder, *Ciala*, according to Ob1cloney1234. [2]

Looking in the Discord server again, the first mention of it seems to be by someone named *Pudd* in the #general chat. Similarly, the same player with the tag *PuddPuddofMaja* was also the first to say the city's name in the Minecraft chat, pointing another player to its very own Discord server, on the 18th of November 2025. [7]

This is just one small part of the very fascinating lore and story of this specific town, and of course there are numerous more dotted around the world. The abandoned ghost city is also referred to as Ctown, which is most likely a portmanteau of *Cialazar* and town.



Inside the city's walls, there were unmanaged stalks of bamboo reaching up to twenty or thirty blocks tall, evident of the city's age and its history. The unmanaged, wild, overgrown bamboo made me feel like I was wading through unmanaged fields in the English countryside, with bees, mosquitoes, and flies all swarming around me as I explored around. The mildly griefed ground also mimicked that unmanaged countryside look; the imperfection and ruggedness gave the city character and tells its once vibrant story.



Another observation I made was the buried chests around the city – a cheap and efficient way that players used to protect their items from raiders and griefers.

These kinds of chests are a direct result of anarchic server design with unrestricted griefing and PvP, forcing less equipped players to have to hide from other players to survive. This is in direct contrast to one of Raid Farm's main goals – to foster communities and player interaction. [3]

Furthermore, this is also another example of the *Griefing Imbalance*, where the effort put into mining, farming, and collecting resources must be hidden away to prevent hostile actors destroying that progress. Players, who ultimately act as people, need a common space, physical or otherwise, to bond and form relationships. However, Raid Farms punished establishments and institutions that represented communities, people, and societies through the imbalance, which furthered the distance between players.

Although, Ctown is the perfect microcosm for Raid Farms, where community exists at the same time as seclusion and scepticism. The server was systematically structured to *be* an anarchy server, but the players inhabit it as if it was an *SMP* server. The balance in between is the amalgamation that produces this small settlement. Although this article does not intend to discuss why the server failed, I believe that even though Raid Farm's intentions as a server mixing the best of both worlds was successful, neither world's players enjoyed the final product.

IV. The Diner



This building had a restaurant/diner on the bottom, with hotel rooms or some kind of flats above.

In a spread out, disconnected server, the more signs a place has, the more people visited it, and found a sense of comfort and belonging, leading them to place a sign to mark their presence in the very rare communal spaces around the map. The “X was here” signs allow players to not just be a random person, a meaningless entity in the server, but is the only way (in Raid Farm’s anarchic server) for its members to share a moment – and most importantly, a space.

I talked about this in my recent video [1] where I explain the effects and mechanisms of healthy and harmful interactions, however it is also worth pointing out the indirect interactions a server’s environment can provide and act upon a player.

Servers have a direct, symbiotic relationship with players, where players influence the environment, and the environment influences the players’ decisions; this means that anything placed in the environment is directly interpreted by bystanders as influential to them, especially so if the structure was made by a player – in Raid Farms, these influential structures are signs.

V. The Compound



The last structure I went to was called The Compound – a small, rectangular, cobblestone structure, with a wheat farm in the middle. There are some chests and barrels dotted around the farm too for storing wheat seeds, but they are all scavenged empty.

The wheat farm being at The Compound’s very centre shows how a server’s mechanisms influences player behaviour greatly. If it was not for wheat’s “value” as a currency (even though it failed, and players did not like it), the people who built this rudimentary building introducing new players would not have a wheat farm as its welcome. This speaks to the actual consequence and effect of the wheat currency, which is as a social glue. In a server that has no real, effective mechanism to draw players into a central, communal area, something else must shape their identity.

You might even be able to draw comparisons between minority diaspora communities with Raid Farms players – groups of people who cannot interact or share experiences together due to some kind of systemic oppression or force, and must use discrete, shared, community spaces where they can interact without outside intervention attempting to pull them apart. Truthfully, the cohesion that Raid Farms players have and showed when Pinecone announced the server's closure was evident – they were never enemies or hostile to each other, but the system in which they live in created the environment where they are not able to interact freely with each other, and even if they were, it was not something that Raid Farms *actively* encouraged.

Conclusion

De jure anarchy servers with a *de facto* SMP playerbase (survival Minecraft players who want to interact with other players and share builds) will always create a stark divide between the system's expected outcome and the players' inherent assumed outcomes on that server. Raid Farms' mechanisms *allowed* its landscape to be griefed, which caused players to spread out because of that fact. However, players have always secretly been yearning for interactions, for community, for someone to play *with*, and this was evident by the masses of screenshots people shared on Raid Farms' Discord server for everyone to reminisce on the systemic oppression of the people's will for community.

References

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